

Atal Bihari Vajpayee and Narendra Modi
March 3, 1999

Photograph by
SHARAD SAXENA

Atal Bihari Vajpayee, then prime minister and the BJP's tallest national figure, holds then BJP general secretary (organisation) Narendra Modi's hand, as they dance during Holi celebrations in New Delhi. The unguarded moment captures personal warmth—and, in hindsight, offers a glimpse of a generational shift in Indian politics that was still some distance away